

Sentence Completion & Vocabulary Basics

Practice Worksheet

Section A: Sentence Completion (15 Questions)

1. Although the initial reviews of the new software were highly _____, later testing revealed several critical bugs.
 - A) negative
 - B) positive
 - C) confusing
 - D) expensive
2. Because the data collected during the first test was _____, the team had to repeat the experiment to get a clear answer.
 - A) definite
 - B) uncertain
 - C) complete
 - D) accurate
3. The corporate culture at the firm was very _____; fresh ideas from new employees were routinely ignored in favor of old, traditional methods.
 - A) modern
 - B) flexible
 - C) old-fashioned
 - D) creative
4. The CEO's speech was unexpectedly _____, delivering the entire company update in just under five minutes.
 - A) long
 - B) brief
 - C) boring
 - D) wordy
5. Despite the team's _____ efforts to fix the broken server, a large portion of the customer data was permanently lost.
 - A) lazy
 - B) brave
 - C) zero
 - D) careless

6. The legal team advised the manager to remain _____ during the meeting, warning that showing too much emotion could hurt the case.

- A) angry
- B) calm
- C) excited
- D) upset

7. The unexpected drop in sales acted as a powerful _____ for the company, forcing them to quickly change their marketing plan.

- A) warning
- B) reward
- C) secret
- D) gift

8. While the senior engineer's method was very _____, relying strictly on step-by-step rules, the intern took a more creative route.

- A) wild
- B) orderly
- C) messy
- D) random

9. The financial analyst warned that the market's current stability was _____, hiding deep problems that would soon cause prices to drop.

- A) permanent
- B) real
- C) fake
- D) safe

10. Due to a _____ of evidence presented by the police, the judge had no choice but to dismiss the case.

- A) lack
- B) crowd
- C) flood
- D) massive amount

11. Although the first design was very _____ and broke down often, the final model was praised for its excellent _____.

- A) reliable ... strength
- B) weak ... dependability
- C) expensive ... cost
- D) perfect ... speed

12. The manager's public apology was seen as completely _____; consequently, the company's reputation continued to get _____.
- A) honest ... better
 - B) fake ... worse
 - C) late ... higher
 - D) funny ... steady
13. While some board members viewed the expansion plan as a _____ move, others feared it was too _____ and might bankrupt the firm.
- A) smart ... safe
 - B) bold ... risky
 - C) weak ... easy
 - D) slow ... fast
14. The new medicine was designed to _____ the physical pain of the disease, though it failed to _____ the actual cause.
- A) increase ... find
 - B) reduce ... cure
 - C) stop ... change
 - D) create ... solve
15. Rather than providing a _____ explanation that settled the argument, the supervisor gave a _____ response that left everyone confused.
- A) clear ... vague
 - B) long ... short
 - C) bad ... good
 - D) quick ... rapid

Section B: Vocabulary Basics & Fill-in-the-Blanks (15 Questions)

16. The manager refused to extend the deadline, stating that the project timeline was absolute and completely _____.
- A) flexible
 - B) unchangeable
 - C) temporary
 - D) open
17. Her presentation was incredibly _____; she explained her points so logically that everyone agreed with her conclusion.
- A) weak
 - B) convincing
 - C) confusing
 - D) long

18. After working in the exact same entry-level position for eight years without a raise, he felt his career had become _____.

- A) active
- B) exciting
- C) stuck
- D) fast

19. The customer service department is known for its _____ approach, always fixing system errors before the client even notices a problem.

- A) slow
- B) active
- C) lazy
- D) late

20. The accounting team discovered a major _____ between the reported expenses and the actual receipts submitted.

- A) match
- B) agreement
- C) difference
- D) connection

21. Over time, the constant arguments between the two partners began to _____ their trust, eventually destroying the business.

- A) build
- B) weaken
- C) protect
- D) support

22. The new safety rules are _____ for all factories; companies that do not follow them will be fined heavily.

- A) optional
- B) voluntary
- C) required
- D) temporary

23. His speech was criticized for being filled with _____ details that had nothing to do with the main business goal.

- A) important
- B) relevant
- C) extra
- D) useful

24. The sudden drop in oil prices caused a _____ shift in the energy market, pushing companies to invest in solar power.

- A) small
- B) massive
- C) minor
- D) hidden

25. The company decided to _____ its old paper filing system and move completely to digital cloud storage.

- A) keep
- B) continue
- C) drop
- A) protect

26. The group of software developers _____ working late tonight to finish the application patch.

- A) is
- B) are
- C) were
- D) have been

27. Each of the store managers _____ required to submit a weekly sales report every Friday afternoon.

- A) are
- B) is
- C) were
- D) have

28. The quality of the newly manufactured smartphone screens _____ checked carefully by the inspection team.

- A) are
- B) were
- C) is
- D) have been

29. Neither the CEO nor his close advisors _____ willing to speak to the media about the recent data leak.

- A) was
- B) were
- C) is
- D) has been

30. Most of the water in the storage tanks _____ contaminated during the flash floods last week.

- A) were
- B) was

- C) are
- D) have been

Answer Key & Detailed Explanations

1. B — 'Although' signals a contrast. Since testing revealed critical bugs, the initial reviews must have been positive.
2. B — 'Because' signals cause-and-effect. Since they repeated it for a clear answer, the initial data was uncertain.
3. C — Semicolon indicates continuation. Ignoring fresh ideas means the culture is old-fashioned.
4. B — 'Under five minutes' denotes a short speech length, making it brief.
5. B — 'Despite' shows contrast. Their brave efforts unfortunately failed to prevent data loss.
6. B — Avoiding visual or verbal emotional outbursts means remaining calm.
7. A — Re-structuring core strategies out of an unexpected drop makes that drop a clear warning.
8. B — 'While' signals contrast with creative layout. Relying on strict rules makes an approach orderly.
9. C — 'Hiding deep problems' implies the current market stability is fake.
10. A — Cases are dismissed by a judge when there is an absolute lack of concrete evidence.
11. B — 'Although' dictates contrast. Breaking down often (weak) sets up the counterpart of excellent dependability.
12. B — 'Consequently' marks a direct flow. If the apology felt fake, corporate reputation went down or grew worse.
13. B — 'While' frames a split layout view. The counterweight to a bold strategy is a highly risky gamble.
14. B — 'Though' indicates a structural limit. The medicine can reduce pain metrics but cannot cure the root cause.
15. A — 'Rather than' shows structural contrast. A vague response directly prevents a clear resolution.
16. B — Absolute project timelines are fixed and unchangeable.
17. B — Logic patterns that build immediate agreement are highly convincing.
18. C — Remaining in an basic unpromoted role for eight straight years leaves a career feeling stuck.
19. B — Solving critical engineering or service snags before a customer encounters them is active.
20. C — Mismatches between reported expense lines and actual physical receipts point to a difference.
21. B — Persistent structural arguments will actively weaken internal team trust.
22. C — Mandatory actions backed by explicit fine penalties mean they are required.
23. C — Content completely disconnected from core presentation mechanics is extra details.
24. B — Radical baseline adjustments across a whole asset market define a massive shift.
25. C — Completely moving tracking structures over to modern digital systems means you drop paper models.

26. A — 'The group' works as a singular collective structural subject, requiring the verb 'is'.
27. B — The indefinite pronoun marker 'Each' acts as a strict singular entity matching 'is'.
28. C — Stripping out the descriptive middleman prepositional phrase leaves 'The quality' (singular), mapping to 'is'.
29. B — Using 'Neither/Nor' paths means the verb mirrors the closer entity. Plural 'advisors' pairs with 'were'.
30. B — Collective measurement pronouns depend on the targeted object. Uncountable 'water' sets a singular matching rule for 'was'.